



Deployment Guide

Launch version — a fresh, complete deployment on Vercel

VERSION
Launch 1.0

DATE
27 September 2026

This guide takes the launch package from the zip file to a live site, with every part switched on and checked. Follow the stages in order: several depend on the one before.

What the launch version includes

The directory, tenders, jobs, news and prices; listing tiers and the staff portal; an email to you for every form submitted.

One advertising position: the top banner on the directory. No online payments: upgrades and bookings arrive as requests and you invoice them. No public sign-in and no reviews. Tender Pro shows as coming soon and collects interest.

THE STAGES

Stage	What happens	Time
0	Accounts, and the decisions to make first	30 min
1	Create the database and run the setup files	30 min
2	Create your administrator account	5 min
3	Load the 618 firms	10 min
4	Email: form notifications to you, and staff sign-in emails	20 min + DNS
5	Put the files on GitHub	15 min
6	Deploy on Vercel with every setting	30 min
7	Connect buildlist.com	15 min + DNS
8	Supabase sign-in settings and two-factor	10 min
9	Check every part before announcing	45 min
10	After launch: the routines that keep it healthy	ongoing

The one rule that matters most

Supabase gives you two keys. The **anon** key is public and belongs in the browser. The **service_role** key bypasses every security rule. It goes only in Vercel (marked Sensitive) and in supabase/.env on your own computer — never in a file you upload, a chat, an email or a screenshot.



STAGE 0 Before you start 30 minutes

Create these accounts. Use a business email you will keep, not a personal one.

Service	What it does for BuildList	Plan
GitHub	Stores the site's files; Vercel builds from it	Free
Vercel	Hosts the site and runs the forms	Pro
Supabase	The database, sign-in and file storage	Free to start
Resend	Emails you every form submission; sends staff sign-in emails	Free to start

TWO DECISIONS TO MAKE NOW

1. **Use Vercel Pro.** The free Hobby plan is for non-commercial use under Vercel's terms, and BuildList is a commercial site.
2. **Keep one copy of the project.** Unzip the package once, into a folder you will keep (for example Documents\buildlist). Delete older copies; two copies is how the wrong file gets uploaded.

ALSO INSTALL ON YOUR COMPUTER

- **Node.js** (nodejs.org, the LTS version) — needed once, in Stage 3.
- **GitHub Desktop** (desktop.github.com) — the website's uploader fails on folders.

STAGE 1 Create the database 30 minutes

1. Go to **supabase.com** → **New project**. Choose the region closest to Uganda. Save the database password in a password manager.
2. Open **SQL Editor** → **New query**. Run each file below from the supabase folder, in this order. Paste the whole file, press **Run**, and wait for "Success" before the next.

#	File	What it does
1	schema.sql	Every table, security rule and storage bucket
2	seed.sql	The 22 categories, districts, tiers and ad positions
3	PATCH-01.sql	Security hardening
4	PATCH-02.sql	Category names, tier privileges, review rules
5	PATCH-03.sql	Specialities, vacancy and article fields, retires Starter
6	PATCH-04.sql	Tables used by a later release (safe to have now)
7	PATCH-05.sql	Firm dashboard, leads — and fixes tier upgrades being undone
8	PATCH-06.sql	Tables used by a later release (safe to have now)
9	PATCH-07.sql	Fuller vacancy pages
10	seed-ads.sql	The directory banner position, with samples never shown to visitors



If a file stops with an error

Do not skip it and carry on — later files depend on it. Every file is safe to run twice, so fix the cause and run the whole file again. If you cannot see the cause, send the exact error message and the file name.

These files were checked for structure but written where no live database was available, so Supabase is the first place they truly run. Reading each result is how any problem is caught early.

3. **Settings → API:** copy the **Project URL**, the **anon public** key and the **service_role** key into your password manager.

STAGE 2 Your administrator account 5 minutes

1. **Authentication → Users → Add user:** your email, a strong password, tick **Auto Confirm User**.

2. In the SQL Editor, run this with your own name and email:

```
insert into staff (user_id, role, name, email)
select id, 'admin', 'Your Name', email from auth.users where email =
'you@yourdomain.com';
```

3. Run it once. It takes your user ID straight from the account, so there is nothing to copy or mistype.

STAGE 3 Load the firms 10 minutes

This must come after every setup file: PATCH-05 fixes a fault that otherwise stops the loader setting firms' tiers.

1. In the project folder, copy `supabase/.env.example` to `supabase/.env`. Open it in Notepad and fill in the Project URL and the **service_role** key.

2. Open Command Prompt and run, one line at a time:

```
cd /d "C:\path\to\buildlist-vercel"
node supabase/migrate.js
```

3. It ends with a count per table. Firms should read **618**. Running it again is safe; it updates rather than duplicates.

STAGE 4 Email: form notifications to you 20 minutes + waiting for DNS

Every form on the site — listing applications, claims, removal requests, quotation requests, tender and vacancy submissions, advertising enquiries, upgrade requests and the rest — emails you the moment it is submitted. This stage switches that on.

1. In Resend, **Domains → Add domain:** `buildlist.com`. Create the DNS records it shows at your domain provider and wait until it says **Verified**. Without this, emails land in spam.
2. **API Keys → Create.** Copy the key — you will add it to Vercel in Stage 6, together with the address the notifications should go to.
3. In Supabase, **Authentication → Emails → SMTP Settings:** enable custom SMTP and enter Resend's SMTP details (host `smtp.resend.com`, port 465, user `resend`, password = your Resend API key). Sender: `hello@buildlist.com`.

Why the SMTP step matters

Staff invitations and password resets are sent by email. Supabase's built-in sender is heavily rate-limited and meant for



testing only; without your own SMTP, those emails stop arriving once a handful have been sent.

STAGE 5 Put the files on GitHub 15 minutes

1. In Windows Explorer, turn on **View → Show → Hidden items**, so you can see `.gitignore` and `.vercelignore`.
2. GitHub Desktop → **File → Add local repository** → choose the folder. When told it is not a repository, choose **create a repository**.
3. Look down the list of files to be committed. **supabase/.env must NOT be there**. If it is, stop: the `.gitignore` file is missing.
4. Summary “Initial deployment” → **Commit to main** → **Publish repository**. Keep it **private**.

STAGE 6 Deploy on Vercel 30 minutes

1. Upgrade your Vercel team to **Pro**.
2. **Add New → Project** → import the repository. Framework Preset: **Other**. Leave build and output settings empty; they come from `vercel.json`.
3. **Before pressing Deploy**, open **Environment Variables** and add the following. Tick **Sensitive** where marked.

REQUIRED

Name	Value	Sensitive
SITE_URL	https://buildlist.com	
SUPABASE_URL	Project URL (Stage 1)	
SUPABASE_ANON_KEY	anon public key	
SUPABASE_SERVICE_KEY	service_role key	Yes

EMAIL NOTIFICATIONS — REQUIRED TO RECEIVE FORM SUBMISSIONS

Name	Value	Sensitive
RESEND_API_KEY	From Stage 4	Yes
FORM_NOTIFY_EMAIL	Your address. For several people, separate with commas: you@buildlist.com, sales@buildlist.com	
FORM_FROM_EMAIL	BuildList.com <hello@buildlist.com> — must be on the domain verified in Resend	

What each notification looks like

The subject says which form and who sent it; urgent ones (claims, removals, quotation requests, enquiries) start with ●. Pressing Reply writes straight back to the person, and a WhatsApp button opens a chat with them. Every submission is also saved in Supabase → submissions, so nothing is lost if an email is missed.

**COMPANY DETAILS — ANYTHING LEFT UNSET IS SIMPLY HIDDEN**

Name	Value	Sensitive
CONTACT_PHONE	e.g. +256 772 123456	
CONTACT_WHATSAPP	Only if different from the phone	
COMPANY_ADDRESS	Registered office	
COMPANY_URSB_NO	URSB registration number	
COMPANY_TIN	URA TIN	

OPTIONAL

Name	Value	Sensitive
CONTACT_EMAIL	Only if not hello@buildlist.com	
ADS_EMAIL	Only if not advertising@buildlist.com	
GA_MEASUREMENT_ID	G-XXXXXXXXXX — also turns on the cookie notice	
FORM_WEBHOOK_URL	Slack or Make.com, if used	Yes
FEATURE_REVIEWS	Leave unset. Reviews are off in the launch version	

4. Press **Deploy**. The build log should end with lines like:

```
Built 706 pages + sitemap (709 URLs) for https://buildlist.com
site-config.js: database connected
```

If the build says REFUSING TO BUILD

The service key has been pasted into SUPABASE_ANON_KEY. That is deliberate protection: replace it with the anon key and redeploy.

5. **Settings → Git → Deploy Hooks**: name it portal, branch main, Create. Copy the URL, add it as BUILD_HOOK_URL (Sensitive), then **Deployments → latest → Redeploy**.

Every time you change a variable

Vercel does not apply a changed variable to a site that is already built. After adding or changing any, go to Deployments → latest → Redeploy.

STAGE 7 Connect buildlist.com 15 minutes + DNS

- Settings → Domains**: add buildlist.com and www.buildlist.com. Create exactly the DNS records Vercel shows.
- If the domain is on Cloudflare, set those records to **DNS only** (grey cloud) and SSL/TLS to **Full (strict)**. An orange cloud stops Vercel issuing the certificate.
- Wait until both domains show as valid in Vercel — usually minutes, occasionally a few hours.



STAGE 8 Sign-in settings and two-factor 10 minutes

1. Supabase → **Authentication** → **URL Configuration**:
 - **Site URL**: <https://buildlist.com>
 - **Redirect URLs**: add <https://buildlist.com/desk-7k2m9x.html>
2. Open the staff portal at <https://buildlist.com/desk-7k2m9x.html> and **bookmark it**. It is deliberately not linked from the site.
3. Sign in. You will be asked to set up two-factor sign-in: scan the code with Google Authenticator or Microsoft Authenticator and enter the six digits. Every staff role must do this.
4. Invite colleagues from **Portal** → **Staff**. Each receives an email to set their own password.

**STAGE 9 Check every part before announcing** 45 minutes

Do these on the live address, on a phone as well as a computer.

Check	What you should see
Homepage on a phone	No sideways scrolling; the menu button opens every page, including Post a Tender or Job
Adverts	A top banner on the directory only; no other page, including the homepage, has one
Advertise page	Register your interest sends you an ADVERTISING ENQUIRY email
Directory	All 22 categories; filter by Tradesmen and a speciality list appears
A listing	WhatsApp and Call buttons, and Claim this listing; no sign-in or reviews
A vacancy page	Facts band, responsibilities, how to apply; nothing overlapping at any width
Portal → edit a vacancy	Every field saves; the change is live on the site at once
Portal → edit a firm → Publish	The change appears on the site about a minute later
Each form on the site	An email reaches you for every one; Reply goes to the sender; it is also in Supabase → submissions
Upgrade on a tier card	An UPGRADE REQUEST email with the firm, plan and price, ready to invoice
Tender Pro on the Tenders page	Shows Coming soon; registering interest emails you
Claim a listing	The claim arrives in Portal → Claims; call the number on the listing before approving
A quotation request	The notification email lists the firms whose tier includes lead alerts

When a check fails

Note what you did, what you expected and what happened, and check Vercel → Logs for the time it happened. That is usually enough to find the cause straight away.

STAGE 10 After launch ongoing

When	Routine
Every day	Post new tenders the day they are advertised — Tender Pro's value depends on it
Every day	Check Portal → Board: claims and removal requests (48-hour promise)
Every week	Update material prices; download a database backup (Supabase → Database → Backups)
Every month	Open Portal → Analytics → Monthly reports owed, and send them
Same day	Answer every UPGRADE REQUEST email with an invoice; switch the tier on in the portal once paid



When	Routine
When ready	Run REMOVE-SAMPLES.sql to clear sample adverts from the portal
Later release	Online payments, Tender Pro, firm sign-in and reviews all come back with the full version

The free Supabase plan pauses after a week without activity

The public site keeps working, but the portal and form storage stop until the project is restored. Move to Supabase's paid plan before staff and customers depend on it.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

Symptom	Cause and fix
Build: REFUSING TO BUILD	Service key in SUPABASE_ANON_KEY. Use the anon key; redeploy
Portal: not connected to a database	SUPABASE_URL or SUPABASE_ANON_KEY missing, or not redeployed
Signed in, portal shows nothing	No staff row for that login — repeat Stage 2 with the same email
Sign-in email never arrives	Custom SMTP not set up (Stage 4), or Resend domain not verified
Emailed link opens localhost	Site URL in Supabase still says localhost (Stage 8)
No email when a form is sent	RESEND_API_KEY or FORM_NOTIFY_EMAIL missing, the Resend domain not verified, or not redeployed; check Vercel → Logs for “[form] email failed”
Publish says nothing is configured	BUILD_HOOK_URL missing, or not redeployed after adding it
Certificate error on the domain	Cloudflare proxy on — set the records to DNS only
Changes not visible	Allow a minute, then hard-refresh with Ctrl+Shift+R
Anything else	Vercel → Deployments → previous → Promote to Production rolls back instantly